

but mostly just mixed media blogs like Facebook. Yes, every Facebook page is basically a blog. Along with the thousands of people doing this for social sustenance or out of pure passion, there are the corporate blogs (more like blog platforms) like the Times of India, Huffington Post, New York Times, Forbes, Autocar, The Economist, and hundreds more than churn out page after page every few hours.

You should start a blog or a YouTube channel if you want to reach out to a mass of people, gain a following, and share a passion or spread a message.

2. Personal/Portfolio

Some people make a website just for the fun of it, to showcase themselves or their work. These websites are usually one or few pages, containing specific mixed media information. There are even platforms like about.me for readymade 'instant' personal websites with literally a little information about you. If you're any kind of artist, you can host your body of work, and if you're a student, you can put up your resumé.

3. Professional/Business

These are the commercial equivalent of the personal/portfolio style websites, in that they are designed to sell a service, or brand a brand image on your brain. If there are products to sell, there are few. These websites must have a crafty copy with a call to action, testimonials to build trust, videos to demonstrate value, and also contain the most crucial contact information. The name of this game is turn casual visitors into interested inquirers. Build your website according to this format if you have an offline business which you would like to market online, or if you're a startup looking for funding.

4. E-commerce

These are websites that have evolved a design with the specific intent of have users buy as many products as easily as possible. They feature multiple levels of categorization and are usually image heavy, because people like to see what they are buying. User reviews on individual product pages are an important tool for users to make decisions about the purchase. Daily discounts and deals are a common tactic to push products and increase sales. E-commerce websites necessarily have tie ups with merchant transaction handlers such as PayPal, PayU, CCAvenue, etc to enable the customer to purchase instantly. Today, the biggest e-commerce websites have massive amounts of traffic and consequently, usage data, which is